TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Tell How You Got to Where You Are in Your Career

Narrate | PPF | Story Interview

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Tell a new colleague how you got into your line of work: when and where it started, the steps in order, what you do now and what is next.

WHO	You work in a small company in Johor Bahru. This week a new sales assistant joined Kumar's team.
SITUATION	On Friday, Kumar takes everyone to lunch at the mamak to welcome him. The new assistant asks you: "So how did you get into this line of work?" Kumar says: "Yes, tell us. I don't know the story either!"
NEED	Neither of them knows your past. They need to hear when and where you started, the steps in order, and what you do now, in about one minute.
GOAL	Tell how you got to where you are: how it started → the steps → now → what's next, and answer one simple question.

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Kumar asks: "So, how did you get into this line of work? Tell us, I don't know the story either!" Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Mei Ling's answer. Mark where each part starts.

Ten years ago, I was a cashier at a hardware shop in Skudai. Then the owner asked me to do his accounts, so I took a night course. After that, I came here. Now I'm an accounts assistant. Every month, I check about 200 invoices and pay everyone's expense claims. Next year, I'd like to start a diploma in accounting, so one day I can be an accountant. The one thing I'm still learning is our new accounts software. At the moment, I ask Ali for help about once a week.

P PAST · HOW IT STARTED

P PRESENT · WHERE I AM NOW

F FUTURE · WHAT'S NEXT

! STILL LEARNING

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Kumar tells a customer how he got into sales. Put his sentences in order: Past → Present → Future → Still learning.

- [ ] Next year, I'd like to do a short course in online marketing.
- [ ] The one thing I'm still learning is writing long emails. At the moment, Siti checks them for me.
- [ ] Eight years ago, I drove a delivery lorry for a furniture shop in Kulai. Then the owner moved me to sales.
- [ ] These days, I look after about 60 customers, and I visit five or six of them every week.

Write the letter: **P** = Past · how it started · **P** = Present · where I am now · **F** = Future · what's next · **!** = Still learning

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

SET THE SCENE

- [ ] Ten years ago, I was …
- [ ] In 2014, I was …
- [ ] After SPM, I worked as …
- [ ] My first job was at …

TELL THE STEPS IN ORDER

- [ ] Then …
- [ ] After two years, …
- [ ] After that, I …
- [ ] …, so I …

WHERE I AM NOW

- [ ] Now I'm …
- [ ] These days, I …
- [ ] Every week, I …
- [ ] I came here … years ago.

WHAT'S NEXT · STILL LEARNING

- [ ] Next year, I'd like to …
- [ ] One day, I hope to …
- [ ] I'm still learning …
- [ ] The one thing I'm still learning is …

LISTENER: ASK AND CHECK

- [ ] Sorry, which year was that?
- [ ] Why did you change?
- [ ] What's next for you?
- [ ] So you started as …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. I was a cashier for two years. [Then / For example, / Because] I moved to accounts.

2. The owner asked me to do his accounts. [or / for example, / so] I took a night course.

3. I was 19. [But … / When … / So …] I got my first job in Skudai.

4. I finished the night course. [For example, / Or / After that,] I came to this company.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. Ten years ago, I _____ a cashier at a hardware shop. (Setting the scene, long ago)
   - ○ was
   - ○ been
   - ○ be
2. The owner asked me to do his accounts, so I _____ a night course. (One step in the story)
   - ○ taken
   - ○ took
   - ○ taking
3. These days, I _____ about 200 invoices a month. (What you do now, every month)
   - ○ check
   - ○ am check
   - ○ checking
4. At the moment, I _____ still learning the new software. (Something still going on)
   - ○ am
   - ○ do
   - ○ have

SLIDE 09 The steps, then now

The steps of your story are finished: Past (was, got, took, came). What you do now or every week: Present (work, check). Something still going on: am / is + -ing.

Ten years ago, I **was** a cashier in Skudai.

Then I **took** a night course, and after that I **came** here.

These days, I **check** about 200 invoices a month.

I'**m** still **learning** the new software.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

P

PAST · HOW IT STARTED

… years ago, I was … at … Then … After that, …

P

PRESENT · WHERE I AM NOW

Now I'm … Every week, I …

F

FUTURE · WHAT'S NEXT

Next year, I'd like to …

!

STILL LEARNING

The one thing I'm still learning is …

SLIDE 11

Story Interview

Tell the career story on your card. Your listener cannot see it: they ask how you got into this line of work, write the steps in order, ask one question and say the story back.

1. Quiet minute: number the facts on your card in order. Round 1 (3:00 each): start → steps → now → next.
2. Listener: fill the note; number the lines 1–4 in the order you heard them. Ask one question. Say it back. Swap.
3. New partners (line B moves one seat). Round 2 (2:00 each): same story, shorter, next column. Aim: numbers 1, 2, 3, 4.
4. New partners. Round 3 (1:00 each), frames closed: speaker's workbook shut, card face down. Listener writes the jobs.

Card 1 · A job in a factory

Card 2 · A food business

Card 3 · A job in property

Card 4 · A job in a kitchen

Listener's note: the career story

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Start: when, where?			
Then: what changed?			
Now: what job?			
Next or still learning			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Kumar asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. How long were you in your first job?
2. Why did you change?
3. What's next for you?

Start with: **I was there for about … years.** · **I changed because …** · **Next year, I'd like to …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

At an open house, a friend of your cousin asks: "How did you start playing badminton?" (Or cooking, running, fishing, or a small side business.) Tell how it started, what changed, what you do now and what's next.

It started … years ago, when I … · **Then …** · **These days, I …** · **Next, I'd like to …**

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Starts by saying when and where it began, before the first event.
- [ ] Tells the steps in an order the listener can write down, with time words (then, after that, after two years).
- [ ] Says what they do now and what is next.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Clear start (when, where)	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Steps in order	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Now and next	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · A job in a factory

You are a new colleague. Ask: “How did you get into this line of work?” Write the steps in order in your note. Ask one question. Then say it back: “So you started as …”

Card 2 · A food business

You are a customer who comes every week. Ask: “How did you start this business?” Write the steps in order in your note. Ask one question. Then say it back: “So you started as …”

Card 3 · A job in property

You are a client looking for a home. Ask: “How did you get into this line of work?” Write the steps in order in your note. Ask one question. Then say it back: “So you started as …”

Card 4 · A job in a kitchen

You meet your partner on a training day. Ask: “How did you get into this line of work?” Write the steps in order in your note. Ask one question. Then say it back: “So you started as …”

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · A job in a factory

Still learning: writing reports · 2019: a colleague hurt his hand; you wanted to stop accidents · Now: safety officer, same factory · 2014: after SPM, machine operator in Pasir Gudang · 2020: safety course · Next: teach first aid

Card 2 · A food business

Next: a small shop · 2021: left the office job · Now: kuih stall, Sunday market, Taman Pelangi · 2015: clerk at a travel agent, JB · Still learning: selling online · 2020: office closed 2 months; you made kuih; neighbours loved it

Card 3 · A job in property

Now: property agent, 15 homes a year · 2017: bought your first condo; a great agent · Next: your own office · 2012: bank teller, Kluang · Still learning: videos · 2018: passed the agent exam; weekends only · 2019: left the bank

Card 4 · A job in a kitchen

2016: moved to the café for better pay · Still learning: baking bread · 2011: washed plates in a hotel kitchen in JB · Next: a food truck · Now: head cook at a café in Mount Austin · 2013: a chef taught you Western food